
THE BEGINNER'S GUIDE TO

Caravan Solar

Clear recommendations, brand comparisons, and shopping lists for Australian caravanners who don't want to become electrical engineers.



Sized for how you travel. Weekender, Tourer, or Full-timer.

Weekender

Tourer

Full-timer

Contents

01 The 60-Second Version
Everything you need to know in one page

02 Your Power Audit
Figure out how much power you actually use

03 What to Buy
Component by component, plain English

04 Brand Comparisons & Shopping Lists
Side-by-side picks with ready-to-use lists

05 System Sizing Check
Make sure the numbers actually work

06 Expensive Mistakes
7 mistakes that cost \$500 to \$2,000

Checklists & Worksheets

Before You Buy, Installer Brief, First Week

THE SHORT VERSION

Every section has a callout box like this one. If you just want to know what to buy, read only these boxes and you'll have your answer in about 5 minutes.

The 60-Second Version

SKIP THIS IF YOU WANT

If you just want the "what to buy" part, go straight to Section 3. But if you want the 60-second version of what you're putting in your caravan, here it is.

The Whole System in Plain English

1. Solar panels sit on your roof and turn sunlight into power.
2. A battery stores that power. This is the fuel tank.
3. A charge controller sits between panels and battery to manage charging safely.
4. A DC-DC charger tops up the battery from your car while you drive.
5. An inverter lets you plug in normal household things (laptop, microwave).
6. A battery monitor is your fuel gauge. It tells you how much power is left.

That's it. Six things. The rest of this guide tells you exactly which ones to buy and what size.

One Quick Concept

You'll see the word watt-hours a lot. It's how we measure daily power use. If something uses 60 watts and runs for 10 hours, that's 600 watt-hours. Your fridge uses about 60W and runs all day, so roughly 1,440 Wh per day.

That daily number drives everything. The battery size, the amount of solar, the whole lot. Section 2 helps you work out yours. It takes about 10 minutes.

Don't stress about being exact. Within 20% is plenty. We add a buffer for the stuff you forget.

Dave and Sarah are tourers. Weeks on the road, mix of caravan parks and free camping. Here's their typical day off-grid:

Daily total: about 2,150 Wh. Add 25% buffer: about 2,700 Wh per day.

Your turn. Use the Power Audit Worksheet at the back. It lists every common caravan appliance with typical power draws.

Which Tier Are You?

Your daily number tells you what kind of system you need. Pick the one that fits:

WEEKENDER

\$1,500 - \$2,500

Under 1,500 Wh/day

Short trips, mostly caravan parks, some free camping. Fridge, lights, phones.

TOURER

\$3,000 - \$5,000

1,500 to 3,000 Wh/day

Weeks on the road, mix of parks and free camping. Fridge, lights, TV, laptops.

FULL-TIMER

\$5,000 - \$8,000+

Over 3,000 Wh/day

Living on the road. Everything above plus microwave, coffee machine, hair dryer.

A NOTE ON AIR CONDITIONING

Running air con off-grid on a standard setup isn't practical. It uses more power than everything else combined. If that's a must-have, you're looking at a specialised 48V system (\$10,000+) or a generator. This guide covers standard 12V setups.

Got your number? Good. From here on, the guide is built around your tier. Every recommendation, every shopping list is matched to Weekender, Tourer, or Full-timer.

What to Buy

Each component gets a quick answer at the top. Trust us? Read the callout boxes and move on. The explanation is there if you want it.

Battery

THE SHORT VERSION

Buy lithium. Not AGM, not gel. Lithium. It costs more upfront but lasts years longer and gives way more usable power. A 200Ah lithium battery is the sweet spot for most people.

The battery is your fuel tank. An AGM "200Ah" battery only gives about 100Ah usable. A lithium "200Ah" gives 160-200Ah usable. You'd need two AGMs to match one lithium, and they weigh twice as much and last 3-5 years vs 10+.

The most common beginner mistake is buying AGM now and upgrading to lithium a year later. That's \$400-\$800 in the bin. Buy lithium from the start.

What to buy by tier:

- Weekender: 100-200Ah lithium
- Tourer: 200Ah lithium (one battery does the job)
- Full-timer: 300-400Ah lithium

Make sure it has a built-in BMS (Battery Management System). All the brands we recommend include one.

Solar Panels

THE SHORT VERSION

Get fixed panels on the roof PLUS a portable folding panel. Roof panels do daily work; the portable is backup for shade. Go monocrystalline.

Fixed panels bolt to your roof and work all day. Portable panels fold out at camp, angle toward the sun, and avoid shade. Most people get both.

A "400W" panel produces about 200-280W in real conditions. That's normal. This guide's sizing already accounts for it.

By tier:

- Weekender: 200W fixed
- Tourer: 300-400W fixed + 160-200W portable
- Full-timer: 400-600W fixed + 200W+ portable

Charge Controller

THE SHORT VERSION

Weekender with under 200W solar: PWM is fine. Everyone else: get MPPT. It squeezes 15-30% more power. Size it at about 1/3 of your solar wattage in amps.

By tier:

- Weekender: 20A PWM or MPPT
- Tourer: 30-40A MPPT
- Full-timer: 40-50A MPPT

DC-DC Charger

THE SHORT VERSION

Charges your battery from the car while you drive. Not optional. A few hours of driving puts a big chunk back in. Buy a REDARC BCDC.

Modern cars have smart alternators that don't work with a direct battery connection. A DC-DC charger sorts this out. A 40A unit gives you 120-160Ah on a 3-4 hour drive.

By tier:

- Weekender: 20A DC-DC charger
- Tourer: 40A DC-DC charger
- Full-timer: 40-60A DC-DC charger

Inverter

THE SHORT VERSION

Get a pure sine wave inverter. NEVER buy modified sine wave. Size it for your biggest appliance. Weekender: 1000W. Tourer: 2000W. Full-timer: 3000W.

Your battery is 12V. Your appliances need 240V. The inverter converts it. Always buy pure sine wave. Modified sine wave saves \$50-\$100 but produces rough power that damages laptops and chargers.

How big? Think about the biggest single appliance: just phones and laptops = 1000W. Microwave = 2000W. Hair dryer = 3000W.

Battery Monitor

THE SHORT VERSION

Buy a Victron SmartShunt (\$130-\$160). Shows your battery level on your phone via Bluetooth. Without a monitor, you're driving without a fuel gauge.

It tells you exactly what percentage you're at, how fast you're using power, and how long until full. Check your battery level from bed. Without it you'll wear out the battery without realising.

Your Complete System at a Glance

All six components. Find your tier:

Component	Weekender	Tourer	Full-timer
Battery	100-200Ah	200Ah	300-400Ah
Solar (roof)	200W	300-400W	400-600W
Solar (portable)	Optional	160-200W	200W+
Controller	20A PWM/MPPT	30-40A MPPT	40-50A MPPT
DC-DC charger	20A	40A	40-60A
Inverter	1000W PSW	2000W PSW	3000W PSW
Monitor	SmartShunt	SmartShunt	SmartShunt

That's your whole setup. Six things, sized for how you travel. Next section turns this into a shopping list with specific brands and prices.

Which Brands to Buy

THE SHORT VERSION

REDARC for DC-DC chargers. Victron for monitoring. Enerdrive for value. Renogy if budget is tight. Mixing brands is fine and often the smartest move.

This guide isn't sponsored by or affiliated with any brand. These are genuine recommendations based on what holds up.

REDARC

The Safe Choice

Australian-made, based in Adelaide. Premium price, excellent build quality. Their BCDC DC-DC charger range is the industry standard.

Buy REDARC for: DC-DC chargers. Think twice for: monitoring (Victron's app is better), and if budget is tight.

Victron

The Smart Choice

Dutch company, since 1975. Best app in the business. If you like checking battery level on your phone, seeing graphs, and getting alerts, Victron's ecosystem is in a league of its own.

Buy Victron for: charge controllers, battery monitors, inverters. Think twice for: requires more separate components than REDARC or Enerdrive.

Enerdrive

The Value Choice

Australian brand (now Dometic). Good quality at lower price than REDARC, 5-year warranty, lifetime tech support. Their eSystem pre-wired boards are close to plug-and-play.

Buy for: batteries, inverters, pre-wired systems. Think twice: narrower product range.

Renogy

The Budget Choice

Chinese brand with AU warehouse. Significantly cheaper. A 200Ah lithium for under \$500 vs \$800+ elsewhere. Good for Weekenders on a tight budget.

Buy for: panels, batteries, starter kits. Think twice: full-timer daily reliance, slower warranty support.

One-Page Comparison

	REDARC	Victron	Enerdrive	Renogy
Made in	Australia	Netherlands	AU (Dometic)	China
Price	Premium	Premium	Mid-range	Budget
Best at	DC-DC	App + monitor	Value + install	Price
Warranty	2 years	5 years	5yr + lifetime	5 years
App	Good	Excellent	Good	Basic
AU support	Excellent	Good	Excellent	OK

Mixing Brands

You don't have to buy everything from one brand. Experienced caravanners mix and match: REDARC DC-DC, Victron monitoring, best-deal panels, Enerdrive battery. Standard electrical connections, not proprietary.

Where to Buy in Australia

- Solar 4 RVs, Caravan RV Camping, My Generator (specialist retailers)
- REDARC, Enerdrive, Renogy sell direct. Victron via distributors.
- Jaycar for cables, fuses, and small bits.

Avoid no-name brands on eBay/Amazon with no Australian warranty.

DON'T FORGET THE SMALL BITS

Everyone budgets for the big components and forgets cables, fuses, Anderson plugs, and mounting brackets. Budget \$100-\$400. The Shopping List Worksheet has a full checklist.

WEEKENDER SHOPPING LIST

\$1,500 - \$2,500

What	Buy This	Cost
Battery	Renogy/Enerdrive 200Ah Li	\$480-\$900
Solar (roof)	1x 200W monocrystalline	\$200-\$350
Controller	20A MPPT (Renogy/Victron)	\$100-\$200
DC-DC charger	REDARC BCDC1220 (20A)	\$200-\$400
Inverter	1000W pure sine wave	\$150-\$300
Monitor	Victron SmartShunt	\$130-\$160
Wiring + bits	Cable, fuses, Anderson	\$100-\$200

Shopping Lists

TOURER SHOPPING LIST

\$3,000 - \$5,000

What	Buy This	Cost
Battery	200-300Ah Li (Enerdrive/Victron)	\$900-\$1,800
Solar (roof)	2x 200W monocrystalline	\$400-\$700
Solar (portable)	1x 160-200W folding	\$300-\$500
Controller	30-40A MPPT (Victron)	\$200-\$400
DC-DC charger	REDARC BCDC1240 (40A)	\$400-\$600
Inverter	2000W PSW (Enerdrive/Victron)	\$350-\$600
Monitor	Victron SmartShunt	\$130-\$160
Wiring + bits	Cable, fuses, Anderson, ext socket	\$150-\$300

FULL-TIMER SHOPPING LIST

\$5,000 - \$8,000+

What	Buy This	Cost
Battery	300-400Ah Li (Victron/Enerdrive)	\$1,800-\$3,000
Solar (roof)	400-600W (2-3 panels)	\$600-\$1,200
Solar (portable)	1x 200W+ folding	\$400-\$700
Controller	40-50A MPPT (Victron)	\$300-\$500
DC-DC charger	REDARC BCDC1250D (50A)	\$500-\$800
Inverter	3000W PSW (Victron/Enerdrive)	\$800-\$1,500
Monitor	Victron SmartShunt/BMV-712	\$130-\$300
Wiring + bits	Heavy cable, fuses, dist. board	\$200-\$400

Checking Your Sizing

THE SHORT VERSION

If you're buying from the shopping lists in Section 4, the sizing is already done. This is a double-check for peace of mind, or for setups that don't fit neatly into one tier.

The Quick Sanity Check

Before you buy, run these three checks. If all three pass, you're good to go.

CHECK 1

Solar vs Battery

Solar watts should be 1.5-2x your battery Ah. E.g. 200Ah battery = 300-400W solar.

CHECK 2

Controller vs Solar

Controller amps should be about 1/3 of solar watts. E.g. 400W solar = 30-40A controller.

CHECK 3

Inverter vs Biggest Appliance

Inverter should be 2x your biggest appliance. E.g. 1000W microwave = 2000W inverter.

All three checks pass? You're done. Go buy it.

Worked Example: Dave and Sarah

Daily use: 2,700 Wh (with 25% buffer). Tourers who drive regularly.

Battery: $2,700 \text{ Wh} / 12\text{V} = 225\text{Ah}$ minimum. With cloudy-day buffer: 400Ah total (2x 200Ah lithium).

Solar: $2,700 / 5.5\text{h} / 0.65 = \sim 760\text{W}$ needed, but DC-DC helps on driving days. They go 400W roof + 200W portable (600W total).

Controller: $400\text{W} / 12\text{V} \times 1.25 = 42\text{A}$. They buy a 50A MPPT.

DC-DC: 40A charger gives $\sim 160\text{Ah}$ on a 4-hour drive.

Inverter: Biggest appliance is 1000W microwave. They get 2000W pure sine wave.

Dave and Sarah's Final System

Component	What They Bought
Battery	2x 200Ah lithium (400Ah total)
Solar (roof)	2x 200W panels (400W)
Solar (portable)	1x 200W folding panel
Charge controller	50A MPPT
DC-DC charger	40A
Inverter	2000W pure sine wave
Battery monitor	Victron SmartShunt
Total cost	~\$4,500 - \$5,500

Sun Hours by Region

If you're doing the longer sizing calculation, here are average daily peak sun hours across Australia:

Region	Good	Poor	Avg
Northern AU (Darwin, Cairns)	5.5-6.5	5.0-6.0	5.5-6.0
Central AU (Alice Springs)	6.5-7.5	5.0-5.5	6.0-6.5
Eastern (Sydney, Melbourne)	5.5-6.5	3.0-3.5	4.5-5.0
Western AU (Perth, Pilbara)	6.0-7.0	3.5-4.0	5.0-5.5
South AU (Adelaide, Flinders)	6.0-7.0	3.5-4.0	5.0-5.5
Tasmania	5.0-5.5	2.5-3.0	3.5-4.0

If you travel up north in winter (like most caravanners do), you get excellent sun year-round. Staying in the southeast through winter means less output. Worth sizing up slightly if that's the plan.

Use the System Sizing Worksheet at the back to run through these calculations with your own numbers.

Expensive Mistakes

If you've followed this guide, you've already avoided all of these. Read through anyway. It's good to know what you're not doing.

Mistake 1: Buying AGM Now, Lithium Later \$400-\$800 wasted

You buy AGM because it's cheaper upfront. Within a year you upgrade to lithium. The AGMs go in the bin. Buy lithium from the start.

Mistake 2: Not Enough Solar for Your Battery \$300-\$1,000+

Big battery, not enough solar. It sits undercharged day after day, wearing out years early. Solar should be 1.5-2x your battery Ah.

Mistake 3: Trusting the Number on the Box \$500-\$1,500

Your "400W" panels produce 200-280W in real conditions. People who don't know this buy too little and wonder why the battery never fills.

Mistake 4: Thin Cables \$200-\$500 to rewire

12V systems need thicker cables than house wiring. Thin cables waste power. Going DIY? One size thicker than you think you need.

Mistake 5: No Battery Monitor

\$500-\$1,500

Without a monitor, you guess how much charge is left. You run it down too far, it wears out faster. A SmartShunt costs \$130-\$160.

Mistake 6: Modified Sine Wave Inverter

\$200-\$500

You save \$50-\$100 on a cheaper inverter that produces rough power. Laptops and chargers stop working properly. Always buy pure sine wave.

Mistake 7: No External Anderson Plug

\$300-\$500 wasted

You buy a portable panel but there's nowhere to plug it in outside. An external Anderson socket costs \$20-\$40 and takes 30 minutes to install.

The Pattern

Every mistake comes from one of three places:

- Buying cheap and replacing later. The right gear once is always cheaper than the wrong gear twice.
- Not knowing how things actually perform. Real-world performance differs from lab specs. This guide accounts for that.
- Skipping the small stuff. Cables, monitors, and Anderson plugs are cheap. The problems they prevent are expensive.

If you bought from the shopping lists in Section 4, you've already avoided all seven.

Before You Buy

THE BASICS

- ☐ Completed the Power Audit (Section 2 or worksheet)
- ☐ Know your daily watt-hours number
- ☐ Identified your tier: Weekender / Tourer / Full-timer

YOUR GEAR

- ☐ Filled in the Shopping List worksheet with specific products
- ☐ Battery is lithium with a built-in BMS
- ☐ Inverter is pure sine wave
- ☐ Included a battery monitor (e.g. Victron SmartShunt)
- ☐ Included an external Anderson plug socket
- ☐ Included cables, fuses, and connectors in your budget

WILL IT FIT?

- ☐ Measured roof space for panels (clear of A/C, antenna, hatches)
- ☐ Checked battery box dimensions
- ☐ Confirmed weight (lithium is usually lighter than AGM)

QUICK SIZING CHECK

- ☐ Solar watts = 1.5-2x battery Ah?
- ☐ Controller amps = $\sim 1/3$ of solar watts?
- ☐ Inverter handles biggest appliance with room to spare?

INSTALLATION

- ☐ Got an installer? Hand them the Installer Brief from this guide.
- ☐ Going DIY? Grab manufacturer installation guides for each component.

What to Tell Your Installer

Print this page and hand it to your installer. It tells them exactly what you want.

My System Specs

Component	What I Want
Battery	_____ Ah lithium (Brand: _____)
Solar (roof)	_____ W total (___ x ___ W panels)
Portable panel	_____ W (with ext. Anderson socket)
Charge controller	_____ A MPPT (Brand: _____)
DC-DC charger	_____ A (Brand: _____)
Inverter	_____ W pure sine wave (Brand: _____)
Battery monitor	Brand: _____

PLEASE MAKE SURE

- ☐ External Anderson plug socket is installed for portable panel
- ☐ Battery monitor is set up and working before you leave
- ☐ All wiring is correctly sized for the system
- ☐ I get a walk-through of the system when done (see next page)

Questions to Ask

1. "Have you installed this brand/setup before?"
2. "Is there anything in my spec list you'd change, and why?"
3. "What's included in the quote and what's extra?"
4. "How long will it take?" (standard tourer = ~1 day)
5. "What warranty do I get on the installation work?"

After Installation Walk-Through

Before the installer leaves, get them to show you:

- ☐ How to read the battery monitor (percentage, charging status)
- ☐ Where the main fuse/isolator is
- ☐ How to connect the portable panel via Anderson plug
- ☐ System is currently working: solar charging, battery level going up
- ☐ Test a 240V appliance through the inverter
- ☐ Their contact number for roadside issues

WHY THIS PAGE EXISTS

Installers are busy. If you walk in with just "I want solar on my caravan," you'll get whatever system they normally install. You've done the homework. This page makes sure you get what you planned for.

Your First Week With Solar

Your system is in. Here's how to get familiar with it. After a week this will all be second nature.

Day 1: Get to Know Your Monitor

- ☐ Find the battery monitor and read it. Should show a percentage.
- ☐ Turn on your usual stuff (fridge, lights). Watch the monitor show power going out.
- ☐ Test the inverter. Plug in phone charger. Then try your biggest appliance.
- ☐ Plug in portable panel via Anderson socket. Confirm extra charging shows.

Day 2-3: Learn the Pattern

- ☐ Check monitor first thing in the morning. 100% to 85% overnight is normal.
- ☐ Check again late afternoon. Back near 95-100%? System is keeping up.
- ☐ Notice the rhythm: battery drops overnight, solar fills during the day.

THE DAILY RHYTHM

Battery drops overnight (fridge), solar fills it during the day. As long as the top-up roughly matches the drawdown, you're golden. If it's hovering around 80% by afternoon, set up the portable panel.

What You'll See (All Normal)

- Battery sits between 70-100% on a typical day
- Solar output is high midday, low morning/evening, zero at night
- Fridge draws power in bursts (compressor cycling on/off)
- Inverter hums quietly when switched on
- Cloudy days produce less solar (1-2 cloudy days is fine)

If Something Seems Off

Battery dropping even though it's sunny?

Check for shade on panels. Move the van or set up portable panel in full sun.

Inverter switches off when you plug something in?

Too much at once. Use one big appliance at a time.

Battery low after a few overcast days?

Drive for a couple of hours. The DC-DC charger will handle it.

After a Week

You'll barely think about it. A quick glance at the battery monitor in the morning becomes like checking the fuel gauge. If the battery stays above 60-70% most of the time, your system is well sized.

That's it. You've got solar on your caravan and you know how to use it.

Power Audit

List every electrical appliance you plan to run off-grid. Check the label for wattage. If it shows amps, multiply by 12 to get watts.

Appliance	Watts	Hrs/Day	Daily Wh
Compressor fridge	50-70	24	_____
LED lights (all)	20-40	____	_____
TV (12V)	30-60	____	_____
Phone charger x ____	10-20 ea	____	_____
Laptop charger	45-65	____	_____
Tablet charger	10-15	____	_____
Water pump	50-70	____	_____
Diesel heater fan	20-40	____	_____
Range hood fan	20-30	____	_____
Radio/speakers	10-20	____	_____
CPAP machine	30-60	____	_____
Electric blanket	40-60	____	_____

Power Audit Worksheet

Appliance	Watts	Hrs/Day	Daily Wh
Hair dryer (inverter)	1200-2000	_____	_____
Microwave (inverter)	800-1200	_____	_____
Coffee machine (inv.)	800-1500	_____	_____
Toaster (inverter)	800-1200	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

Subtotal: _____ Wh

+ 25% buffer (x 1.25): _____ Wh

Your Traveller Tier

Under 1,500 Wh

Weekender

1,500-3,000 Wh

Tourer

Over 3,000 Wh

Full-timer

My tier: _____

My daily total: _____ Wh

System Sizing

Daily power use (from Power Audit):

_____ Wh

STEP 1

Battery Size

Daily Wh / 12V / 0.85 (lithium usable) = minimum Ah

_____ Wh / 12 / 0.85 = _____ Ah (minimum)

_____ Ah x 1.5 = _____ Ah (with 1 day reserve)

Your battery choice: _____ Ah lithium

STEP 2

Solar Panel Wattage

Daily Wh / peak sun hours / 0.65 (real-world efficiency) = total solar watts

_____ Wh / _____ hours / 0.65 = _____ W

Fixed panels: _____ W

Portable: _____ W

STEP 3

Charge Controller Size

Fixed panel wattage / 12V x 1.25 (safety margin) = controller amps

_____ W / 12 x 1.25 = _____ A

Your charge controller: _____ A MPPT

System Sizing Worksheet

STEP 4

Inverter Size

Add up 240V appliances you'd run simultaneously, multiply by 1.2 for surge.

Total simultaneous: _____ W x 1.2 = _____ W

Your inverter: _____ W pure sine wave

STEP 5

DC-DC Charger

Weekender: 20A. Tourer: 40A. Full-timer: 40-60A.

Your DC-DC charger: _____ A

Complete System Summary

Component	Spec	Brand/Model	Est. Cost
Battery	___Ah Li	_____	\$_____
Solar (fixed)	___W	_____	\$_____
Solar (portable)	___W	_____	\$_____
Controller	___A MPPT	_____	\$_____
DC-DC charger	___A	_____	\$_____
Inverter	___W PSW	_____	\$_____
Monitor	_____	_____	\$_____
Wiring + fuses	_____	_____	\$_____
TOTAL			\$_____

QUICK CROSS-CHECK

- ☐ Solar watts = 1.5-2x battery Ah?
- ☐ Controller amps = ~1/3 of solar watts?
- ☐ Inverter = 2-3x biggest 240V appliance?
- ☐ All three pass? System is balanced. Go buy it.

Shopping List

My tier: _____

Budget range: \$ _____

Battery

_____ Ah lithium (LiFePO4)

Brand: _____

Price: \$ _____

Must have built-in BMS. Check dimensions fit battery box.

Solar (Fixed)

_____ W total (___ panels x ___ W)

Brand: _____

Price: \$ _____

Monocrystalline. Check physical size fits roof.

Solar (Portable)

_____ W folding panel

Brand: _____

Price: \$ _____

Check it comes with Anderson plug connector.

Charge Controller

_____ A MPPT

Brand: _____

Price: \$ _____

Check max input voltage matches panel config.

DC-DC Charger

_____ A

Brand: _____

Price: \$ _____

Check compatibility with vehicle alternator.

Inverter

_____ W pure sine wave

Brand: _____

Price: \$ _____

Must be PSW. Check outlet types (GPO, USB).

Battery Monitor

Shunt-based with Bluetooth

Brand: _____

Price: \$ _____

Wiring and Accessories

Item	Spec	Qty	Price
Battery cable (pos)	___ mm ²	___ m	\$___
Battery cable (neg)	___ mm ²	___ m	\$___
Solar cable	4mm ² twin	___ m	\$___
Anderson plugs (50A)	Standard	___ pairs	\$___
Ext. Anderson socket	Weatherproof	1	\$___
Bus bars (+/-)	Rated for system	2	\$___
ANL fuse + holder	Rated for battery	1	\$___
Blade fuses (assorted)	Fuse box or individual	___	\$___
MC4 connectors	For solar panels	___ pairs	\$___
Cable ties + clips	Assorted	1 pack	\$___
Mounting brackets	For panels	___ sets	\$___

Total Budget

Category	Estimated Cost
Battery	\$_____
Solar (fixed + portable)	\$_____
Charge controller	\$_____
DC-DC charger	\$_____
Inverter	\$_____
Battery monitor	\$_____
Wiring + accessories	\$_____
Total components	\$_____
Installation (if applicable)	\$_____
GRAND TOTAL	\$_____

- ☐ Power audit completed
- ☐ System sizing completed
- ☐ Physical dimensions checked (panels fit roof, battery fits box)
- ☐ Budget includes wiring and accessories

You're all set.

You've got your tier, your shopping list, and your checklists. Everything you need to get solar on your caravan without second-guessing yourself.

YOUR RESOURCES

- **Power Audit Worksheet**
Work out your daily watt-hours
- **System Sizing Worksheet**
Size every component to your usage
- **Shopping List Worksheet**
Track brands, specs, and costs
- **Before You Buy Checklist**
Final check before you spend
- **Installer Brief**
Hand this to your installer
- **First Week Checklist**
Get comfortable with your system

WHAT TO DO NEXT

1. Complete your Power Audit worksheet
2. Identify your tier (Weekender, Tourer, Full-timer)
3. Fill in your Shopping List from Section 4
4. Complete the Before You Buy checklist
5. Hand your installer the Installer Brief, or order online

Caravan Solar
caravansolar.au

Questions? Updates? New versions?
Visit caravansolar.au